



NEWS | BAY AREA & STATE

SF: Police Say License Plate Readers 'Improperly' Accessed By Out-Of-State, Fed Agencies

By Bay City News Service

June 17, 2026



FILE - A Flock Safety camera, an automatic license plate reader system, operates in Ukiah, Calif. on Tuesday, March 18, 2025. Flock Safety camera systems are used by law enforcement and communities to capture vehicle license plate photos to identify vehicles that are connected to ongoing criminal investigations. (Sydney Fishman/Bay City News)
Sydney Fishman/Sydney Fishman/Bay City News



 Listen Now:

**SF: Police Say License Plate Readers 'Improperly' Accessed
By Out-Of-State, Fed Agencies**
About 2 Minutes

1x



 Everlit

San Francisco police say they have disabled access to its network of Flock Automated License Plate Reader cameras after it was "improperly queried" for out-of-state and federal agencies.

We use technologies that provide information about your interactions with this site to others for functionality, analytics, targeted advertising, and other purposes. [Learn more in our Privacy Notice](#). You agree that your use of this website and the Hearst Services is governed by the [Terms of Use](#) (including the [dispute resolution procedures](#)).

Friends of SFGATE enjoy ad-free reading and more in our new app.

GET IT NOW

"The audit did not find any inquiries referencing immigration enforcement or reproductive rights investigations, and the federal agencies identified do not include Immigration and Customs Enforcement or the Department of Homeland Security," police said Wednesday night in a statement.

Automatic license plate reader technology provides a tracker system that helps multiple law enforcement agencies identify vehicles associated with criminal suspects, witnesses and victims, as well as point out drug trafficking, stolen vehicles and Amber Alerts.

California law places clear restrictions on sharing license plate reader information

We use technologies that provide information about your interactions with this site to others for functionality, analytics, targeted advertising, and other purposes. [Learn more in our Privacy Notice](#). You agree that your use of this website and the Hearst Services is governed by the [Terms of Use](#) (including the [dispute resolution procedures](#)).

"NCRIC and WSIN's access to SFPD ALPR network currently remains disabled," police said.

The intelligence center's website says it is part of the U.S. Department of Homeland Security's information sharing strategy and serves as the regional "all major crimes" intelligence fusion center for the federal Northern District of California.

Some Bay Area cities ousted license plate reader camera manufacturer Flock Safety after privacy watchdogs raised concerns about federal agencies being able to access the camera data and using it for targeted surveillance.

All the queries to SFPD's network were simultaneously made to between 531 and 763 other law enforcement agencies, police said.

ADVERTISEMENT

Article continues below this ad



BECOME A FRIEND. GET OUR AD-FREE APP.

Access our new app with ad-free reading, curated maps and more.

GET IT NOW

The department said it previously authorized license-plate data sharing with NCRIC as allowed by state law. No out-of-state or federal agencies ever had direct access to SFPD's Flock system, it said.

"Upon discovering the improper searches, Chief Derrick Lew immediately turned off NCRIC's access to SFPD's ALPR system and initiated an internal review," police said.

ADVERTISEMENT

Article continues below this ad

News, Inc. is prohibited. Bay City News is a 24/7 news service covering the greater Bay Area.

June 17, 2026

Around The Web

Powered by **REVCONTENT**

The Supportive Bra Women Over 50 Are Loving

By **imgainting**

After 60, Leg Strength Comes From One Simple Daily Move

By **ApexLabs**

Cardiologist Warns Americans: "Pour Out the Bottled Water"

By **Gundry MD**

If You Get Social Security, Don't Skip This September Benefit Check

Restaurants In Santa Clara With Good Senior Discounts

By **Comparisons.org**

If You're Collecting Under \$3950 In SS a Month: You're Eligible for These 10 ...

We use technologies that provide information about your interactions with this site to others for functionality, analytics, targeted advertising, and other purposes. [Learn more in our Privacy Notice](#). You agree that your use of this website and the Hearst Services is governed by the [Terms of Use](#) (including the [dispute resolution procedures](#)).

Just Add 1 Drop Of This Household Item To Any Dark Spot and Wait 3 Minutes

By [Gundry MD](#)

How to Beat Spinal Stenosis: The Hidden Cause Most Doctors Miss

By [SmoothSpine](#)

Timeshare Resorts Forced To Refund Owners – Is Yours On the List?

By [SilverPenny](#)

10 Strangely Useful Walmart Finds Nobody Thinks Of

By [PopularDiscovery](#)

7 Things Changing for Seniors On Social Security In 2027

By [HealthyWallet](#)

Don't Borrow from the Bank If You Own a Home, Borrow from Yourself Instead (I...

By [Comparisons.org](#)

Let's Play



Cross|word



Pile-Up Poker



Typeshift



Really B.

SFGATE

Top ^



We use technologies that provide information about your interactions with this site to others for functionality, analytics, targeted advertising, and other purposes. [Learn more in our Privacy Notice](#). You agree that your use of this website and the Hearst Services is governed by the [Terms of Use](#) (including the [dispute resolution procedures](#)).

Services



Quick Links



H E A R S T *newspapers* © 2026 Hearst Communications, Inc. [Terms of Use](#) | [Privacy Notice](#) | [CA Notice at Collection](#) |

[Your CA Privacy Rights \(Shine the Light\)](#) | [DAA Industry Opt Out](#) |



[Your Privacy Choices \(Opt Out of Sale/Targeted Ads\)](#)

We use technologies that provide information about your interactions with this site to others for functionality, analytics, targeted advertising, and other purposes. [Learn more in our Privacy Notice](#). You agree that your use of this website and the Hearst Services is governed by the [Terms of Use](#) (including the [dispute resolution procedures](#)).